Round 4, run 3 – Egyptian wisdom and creation: done (first draft)

▼ Contents

Done 1
Verification (final state) 3
Key findings 4
Decisions taken (minor, by me and the sub-sessions; all recorded in `renderings.md` §10) 6
Questions for the user 6
Problems and skipped items 7
Cross-corpus splits left for the lead 8

Child session `session_016VYybQrHJEd4FJNsbr7Be9` (`Round4/Run3`), 2026-10-23 18:31 – 2026-10-24 ~01:40 UTC.
Coordinator: this session. The texts were translated by **two sub-sessions** (guidelines §5.1a), one after the other,
each with its own strictly sequential sub-agent chain; their reports are `run-3--sub-1.md` (Amenemope) and
`run-3--sub-2.md` (the creation texts and the Heavenly Cow) – the details below are summarized from them. Model: Opus 5.5
throughout (the Memphite transcription agent too: reading diacritics from page images is not mechanical enough for a
cheaper model). No quota stop: `rate_limit_info.status` was `allowed` before every sub-agent and sub-session.

Done

A new corpus, `חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים/` (the folder's first Egyptian corpus), set up by the coordinator before the
first line (commits bc38bf8, 1a09ee3, 81a0801):

- **Base texts:** AED-TEI (the TLA's 2018 snapshot as TEI, CC BY-SA 4.0, committed) fetched per text from raw GitHub – `zenodo.org` was unreachable; the live TLA was never touched. Amenemope (pBM EA 10474 + five older witnesses), Merikare (three witnesses), the Heavenly Cow (Seti I, Tutankhamun, Ramesses VI), PT 571, 486, 527, 600, pWestcar, the Bremner-Rhind Apophis books. The Memphite Theology is not in AED: **El Hawary 2010** (OBO 243, ZORA, open access) – its text layer garbles Egyptological letters, so a sub-agent transcribed his transliteration from the page images (`memphite-transliteration.tsv`, 88 rows, committed as the reading of a public-domain ancient text, with attribution; the PDF, his German and notes git-ignored). Rank 3–5: the TLA's German, **Hornung 1997** (the Cow, OBO 46), **Lange 1925** (Amenemope, PD OCR).
- **Tools:** `tools/aed2md.py` (AED TEI → line data); `egypt_tools.py` (data / tr / fill / lex / lemma / verify / build / grep / gates / selftest); `build_parallels_index.py`.
- **Reference files:** `renderings.md` (the name table; the transliteration convention ṯ `צ׳`, ḏ `ג׳`; the grammar mapping Middle / Late Egyptian → Hebrew; key terms; the reserved words with tested gates – the Gen 1–2 and 6–9 words never, the Egyptian **loanwords** only for their own source, Proverbs' and the Torah's key words licensed by their Egyptian counterparts; formulas; **§8 the Amenemope ↔ Prov 22:17–24:22 / Torah table**, checked against the TLA before drafting), `translator-brief--egyptian.md` (the ★ rules), `corpus.md`, `parallels-index.md`.

Project	Text	Lines	By
1-מוסר-אמנמופה/	The Instruction of Amenemope (AM), prologue, 30 houses, epilogue, colophon	551	Sub1: two translators (parts 1–2, 3–5), three reviewers
2-בריאה-במצרים/	Merikare E130–138 (MK); Pyramid Texts 571, 486, 527, 600; the Memphite Theology, all of El Hawary's edition (MT)	9 + 18 + 88 = 115	Sub2: translator 1, three reviewers
3--ספר-הפרה-השמימית/	The Book of the Heavenly Cow, Seti I (HC), with the older copies in the apparatus	95	Sub2: translator 2
(the Ugaritic corpus's 3--תיק-היום-החמישי/)	the fifth-day dossier: pWestcar's wax crocodile (WC) and the Bremner-Rhind Apophis spells (AP), the items run 1 left to this run	2 excerpts	Sub2: one agent

Files per project: `annotated-<KEY>.rtl.md`, `translation--intro-<KEY>.rtl.md`, the generated `translation-<KEY>.rtl.md` and `translation.rtl.md`, `project.md`. Print stubs: `הדפסה/{1-מוסר-אמנמופה,2-בריאה-במצרים/חכמה-ובריאה-במצרים,3-ספר-הפרה-השמימית}.rtl.md`.
The dossier's Merikare lines (E130–136) were aligned with project 2's Hebrew (six revisions, with reasons).

Shared files, updated once at the end (this commit): `STATUS.md` (§3 row, §4 run 3), the plan row, guidelines §5.2
(three lessons) and §6.7 (the Egyptian corpus; its traps), `history.md`, `sources-registry.md` §4.4t, `tools.md`,
`sources/fetch-recipes.tsv` + `MANIFEST.json` (the two ZORA PDFs and their derived files: new items only),
`sources/Hornung-.../.gitignore`. `domains.txt` needed nothing new (raw GitHub, ZORA, archive.org were listed).

Verification (final state)

- `egypt_tools.py verify --strict` (all eight KEYs): AM 551/551, MK 9, PT571 4, PT486 3, PT527 4, PT600 7, MT 88, HC 95 –
  0 problems, 0 repeated-line differences; translation files equal the `>` lines.
- `egypt_tools.py selftest`: 31 lines, 0 failures.

- `3-תיק-היום-החמישי/dossier_tools.py verify --strict`: 0 problems (8 excerpts).
- `tools/check_bible_quotes.py` on every `.md` of the corpus, the dossier, the print stubs, `translation-guidelines.md`, `STATUS.md`, `history.md`: **0 problems**.
- `build_parallels_index.py`: 805 rows; the key findings are at the top of `parallels-index.md`.
- Three review passes (fidelity, consistency, Hebrew) per text, each by a fresh reviewer, logged in the `project.md` files.
- (`ugarit_tools.py verify` could not run here: the CUC base is git-ignored and not restored in this VM; the Ugaritic tablets were not touched – only the dossier, which has its own verifier, passed.)

Key findings

For the Bible

1. **Amenemope ↔ Prov 22:17–24:22, saying by saying, on the transliteration:** "give your ears" (3.9) against `הַט אָזְנְךָ` [divergence]; the oldest witness has "inside your belly" (Prov 22:18 `בְּבִטְנֶךָ`); the hot man (11.13–14, 13.8–9) and Prov 22:24–25 in the same order; wealth "made itself wings like geese" (10.3) against `כִּי עָשֹׂה יַעֲשֶׂה-לּוֹ כְנָפַיִם כְּנָשֶׁר` (Prov 23:5) – same verb and noun, another bird; "the bowl that is before you" (23.16) = `אֶת-אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֶיךָ` (Prov 23:1); the thirty houses (27.7) behind `שָׁלְשִׁים` (Prov 22:20).
2. **The Torah's laws of boundary, measure and the weak:** the boundary stone and the widow's boundary (7.12–15 ↔ Deut 19:14, 27:17; Prov 23:10, whose `גְּבוּל עוֹלָם` is emended to `גְּבוּל אַלְמָנָה` from this line); two words for the balance as in Prov 16:11 `פֶּלֶס וּמֹאזְנֵי`; the oipe "that takes two" (18.21) ↔ `אֵיפָה וְאֵיפָה` (Deut 25:14) – `אֵיפָה` is the Egyptian word itself – and the false measure is the god's "abomination"; the blind, the dwarf, the lame (24.9 ↔ Lev 19:14); the widow in the field and the stranger (26.9–11 ↔ Deut 24:19–21); two thirds of a poor man's debt released (16.5–7: a [divergence] from Deut 15); "man is clay and straw, the god his builder" (24.12–13 ↔ Gen 2:7, Job 33:6).
3. **"Not yet" (Gen 2:4b–5):** the Pyramid Texts' `n ḫpr.t X` (PT 571, 486) is the exact frame of `טֶרֶם יִהְיֶה`; and in Egypt **death itself "came into being"** (Gen 2:17 [divergence]).

4. **The Memphite Theology:** creation by heart and tongue, "the mouth that devised the name of every thing" (Gen 2:20,
   Ps 33:6, 9); "Ptah rested (ḥtp) after he had made everything" (59): נָח as Ex 20:11 וַיִּנַּח, with no day and no
   number (Gen 2:2 [divergence]); kꜣ.t "his work" מְלָאכָה (Gen 2:2); a worm-eaten ancestral book recopied by Shabaka –
   Hezekiah's contemporary (Prov 25:1).
5. **Merikare:** mankind as the god's flock and "his images", for whom he made heaven, earth, breath, plants, birds and
   fish (Gen 1:26–30, 2:7), punishing only the plotters (Gen 6:5–7 [divergence]).
6. **The Heavenly Cow ↔ Gen 6–9, 11**, with every reserved root of the flood story kept out of the lines: the god's change
   of heart is weariness, not regret (Gen 6:6 [divergence]); mercy by a trick of red beer, no chosen survivor; "never
   again" (Gen 8:21); heaven and earth separated (Gen 11); jw=j jm=j "I (am) I" (49) against Ex 3:14; Thoth installed
   "in my place" (Gen 41:40).
7. **The dossier (Gen 1:21):** Westcar's wax crocodile "became a crocodile of seven cubits" in the hands of a lector priest
   whose title gave Hebrew חַרְטֹם – the form of Ex 7:10–12 וַיְהִי לְתַנִּין, with msḥ where Hebrew has תַּנִּין; the
   Apophis spells curse the water serpent with childlessness (the reverse of Gen 1:22's blessing).
8. **Loanwords in their own contexts:** תֵּבָה (AM 11.4, the coffin), חָתַם, אֵיפָה (sin "sealed with his finger",
   19.21 ↔ Job 14:17), הָבְנִים, כָּתָם, יְאֹר; and Semitic loans in Late Egyptian (ʿšq עָשַׁק, mkmr.t מִכְמֹרֶת).

For the ancient mind

- A land surveyor's conscience: his sins and punishments are those of his trade (boundary stones, measures, tax lists).
- The "hot" and the "silent" man as two trees (one floated off and burned, one flourishing in its garden); silence as power.
- Measures as divine eyes (the Udjat, the oipe as the Eye of Re); Thoth's baboon at every market balance.
- Life as a Nile voyage: the tongue the steering oar, the Lord of All the pilot; "no one is sinless", in a culture whose
  dead declare their innocence forty-two times.

- A creator who withdraws from the world out of old age and weariness; night, war and the separated sky begin after
  mankind's rebellion; creation as thought, word and pun (Shu from a sneeze, Tefnut from spitting).
- Magic as a gift of god (Merikare) and a regulated force (the Cow); the uncreated serpent destroyed every day.

Decisions taken (minor, by me and the sub-sessions; all recorded in `renderings.md` §10)

- The **corpus design**: three projects; the Memphite Theology from our transcription of El Hawary (committed; the PDF
  ignored); Pyramid Texts: the Pepi I copies of 571 and 486 (the older), Merenre's 527, Pepi II's 600.
- **Renderings fixed before drafting** (§4–§6), among them: sbꜣ.yt = מוּסָר (תּוֹרָה never; Prov 1:8 [equivalent]); a
  chapter "house" = בַּיִת; the two hearts לֵבָב / לֵב; pꜣ šmm = הַחַם (always vocalized: Ham); Re = רַא (never
  רע); msḥ = תִּמְסָח (תַּנּוּר never); jp.t = אֵיפָה [loanword]; ꜣḫ X r Y = Yמִ֫ X מוּטָב (טוֹב only nfr); ḥtp =
  נָח; n ḫpr.t = טֶרֶם.
- Sub1: the refrains fixed by their first copies (renderings §7: 3.17 = 5.18 = 17.15; 4.2 = 7.10; 5.19 = 17.16; 8.10 =
  13.9; 9.6–8 = 16.12–14; 22.5–8 = 23.8–11 – correcting my pre-set list); ~120 lemmas merged; the cross-language
  cognate rule scoped (loanwords and rare technical words, not common Semitic vocabulary: §5.2 now says so).
- Sub2: kꜣ.t "work" = מְלָאכָה (so the Memphite Theology shows Gen 2:2); the dossier's Merikare lines aligned; the root
  שחת gated; סְגֻלָּה withdrawn from Egyptian lines (the law corpus's *sikiltu*); gates widened (never the Hebrew bent).
- The optional dossier items (Westcar, Apophis) were done, being cheap after the main work.

Questions for the user

None blocks anything; each line carries the chosen reading with the alternative in its note. Optional:

Where	Question	Now
AM 25.7, 25.9, 26.14, 27.12, 15.7	*twr* split by construction: נְטָהַר / הוֹקִיר / הִנָּזֵר מִן (no Hebrew verb holds "keep away from", "respect" and "be pure") – keep the split?	split
AM 2.8, 2.12	"true of voice" (= the late): of Amenemope's father or of Amenemope himself?	open in the notes
MT (all)	ḥtp = נח in every verbal use (so Ptah's "rest" in 59 is the same word as the reconciliation of Horus and Seth), or by sense with נח only in 59?	נח everywhere
HC 27, 15	the TLA's "I will never kill them" / "Do not diminish them!" against Hornung's "I will kill them without exception"	the TLA, marked ?
MK E134	"rulers *of perfume*" (our base, pCarlsberg) or "in the egg" (pMoscow, the usual reading)	the base, marked

Problems and skipped items

- **Nothing skipped.** No quota stop. The VM rebooted several times while waiting; nothing was lost (everything pushed).
- **A converter bug, found and fixed during Sub1:** the TLA's <gap/> between two analyses of one written stretch was printed as [...] when the analyses spanned several words; nine Amenemope lines had been translated with both analyses side by side; the fidelity reviewer caught it, the tool was fixed and the lines retranslated.
- **Open textual points for a later session:** AM 27.17–28.1 line ends (AED marks loss; the TLA's German and Lange show none: check the BM photographs); the Memphite transcription's doubtful signs (30b [Stš], 61 šnw.t: a broken sign read as š) – a check against Sethe 1928 (PD) would settle them.
- Two ★ slips caught by the translators themselves (a prologue drafted vocalized, rewritten plene; Lange's German once written from memory, replaced from the OCR); one translator read the TLA's German before finishing HC 32–48 (recorded).
- ugarit_tools.py verify not run (CUC not restored here; the Ugaritic tablets untouched).

Cross-corpus splits left for the lead

- **Common Semitic words shared by sense across languages** (Sub1's ruling, now in §5.2): אַלְמָנָה (ḫꜣr.t / *almattu*), שֵׁכָר (ḥnq.t / *šikaru*), מִדָּה (dbḥ / *maddattu*), טִיט (ʿmʿ.t / *ṭiṭṭu*), תֶּבֶן (dḥꜣ / *tibnu*), כָּבֵד (dns / *kabtu*) – [cognate] in Akkadian lines, [equivalent] in Egyptian ones: confirm for every corpus.
- הֲבָנִים: Gudea's Sumerian *esi* (by sense) and Westcar's hbnj (the Egyptian etymon of the loanword): by the cognate rule the Egyptian word owns it – confirm or move *esi*.
- וְזִיר (HC ṮꜢtj by sense = the cross-corpus word of *sukkallu*); סוֹכֵן (AM rwḏ.w, Gudea *aĝrig*, the Advice *šatammu*, all by sense); חוֹכֵר (AM ʿḥwtj) chosen to leave אָרִיס to *errēšu*.
- נָצַר / שָׁמַר for the Egyptian protect-words (nḏ, zꜣw, mkj): the Akkadian reservations applied as Akkadian-only.
- נַחֲלַת־הָאֵל (HC ḫr.t-nṯr) beside Ugaritic *nḥlt* (Mot's land): kept as common Hebrew; חֶלְקַת־הָאֵל is the alternative if the Ugaritic echo should stay out.
- The fifth-day dossier now has eight excerpts; its parallels table is hand-made (`build_parallels_index.py` does not read it).